

Rosstulla School
‘Together Towards Tomorrow’



Health and Safety policies including

First Aid

Administration of medication

Fire Safety

Emergency Evacuation Procedures

Agreed by Governing Body, October 2024

Chairperson's Signature _____ **Date:** _____

Objective

The objective of this policy is to ensure, so far as is "reasonably practicable", that no person is placed in a situation where injury or ill health may be caused as a result of the school and that all such risks are assessed and appropriately controlled.

Rationale

The health and safety of all pupils, staff and visitors to the premises and grounds of Rosstulla School remains our top priority. This policy has been developed and adopted by the governors with reference to the advice and procedures contained in the Health and Safety Policy of the former North-Eastern Education and Library Board (August 2004) now Education Authority (EA) North Eastern Region (NER).

Rosstulla recognises and accepts its responsibility for health and safety as an employer, and in particular the duties laid down in:

- Article 4 (Employers Duties) of the Health & Safety at Work (Northern Ireland) Order 1978;
- Articles 5 and 6 of that Order in respect to persons other than its employees; and
- Article 88 of the Education and Libraries (Northern Ireland) Order 1986.

Where reasonably practicable the school will pay particular attention to the provision and maintenance of:

- a safe place of work, safe access to it and safe egress from it;
- plant, equipment and systems of work that are safe;
- safe arrangements for the use, handling, storage and transport of articles and substances;
- sufficient information, instruction, training and supervision to enable all employees to avoid risk and contribute positively to health and safety at work;
- a healthy working environment; and
- adequate welfare facilities.

So far as is reasonably practicable, we will provide and maintain up-to-date information for all staff on the hazards and risks of substances, equipment and systems used at work including the recommendations of relevant risk assessments. The school will rely on EA to provide competent technical advice on safety and health matters and, where necessary, to assist in effecting improvements.

The school will co-operate fully with queries from staff representatives and recognised trade unions. It is mindful of its responsibility to consult with all members of staff on issues of health and safety.

Staff are reminded of their duties under Article 8 of the Health and Safety at Work (Northern Ireland) Order, 1978: to take reasonable care for their own safety and that of others.

The school has a Health and Safety Team to monitor and increase the effectiveness of its Health and Safety Policy. The team meets termly.

The Board of Governors

This school's board of governors recognise their statutory duty to ensure health and safety on premises under their control. They also acknowledge their responsibility to ensure that the Education Authority's (EA) health and safety policy is both understood and implemented in their school, that risk assessments are carried out to address significant risks, and that they operate within the procedures and guidelines set out in the employing authority's scheme of management.

In fulfilling these duties and responsibilities the board of governors will:

- ensure that the school principal and management team develop a safety management system throughout the school;
- monitor the effectiveness of the school's health and safety arrangements;
- develop and implement arrangements to ensure that:
 - all school risk assessments are completed and are implemented;
 - equipment and materials purchased by the school are safe and suitable for their intended use;
 - contractors carry out their work in a safe manner;
 - prompt and efficient maintenance is carried out on:
 - all non-structural repairs;
 - all equipment;
- ensure that arrangements are developed for the annual inspection of the school premises; and adopt a Plan, Do, Check, Act system in dealing with any issues arising from this inspection.

- ensure that both teaching and non-teaching staff are issued with a copy of the employer's health and safety policy.

The Principal

The principal has overall responsibility for the health, safety and welfare of all children and staff and for ensuring that members of the general public who may be affected by any activity undertaken by or on behalf of the school are not exposed to reasonably foreseeable risks to their health or safety.

The principal is responsible for the day-to-day application of the Health and Safety Policy. In discharging this responsibility the principal will:

- ensure that all teaching staff hold appropriate qualifications both to teach the subjects required of them and to use the necessary equipment and machinery;
- ensure that both teaching and non-teaching staff are provided with training that will help them work safely;
- ensure the provision and maintenance of procedures for the safety of all teaching and non-teaching staff;
- ensure that all staff are aware of any instructions or safety advice pertaining to their particular discipline issued by EA or DENI;
- ensure that all safety reports pertaining to the school are understood and that the detailed work has been completed;
- ensure that adequate arrangements exist for carrying out regular fire drills and that all staff are aware of, and participate in, such arrangements;
- ensure that safe systems of working are used by contractors or persons carrying out inspections or non-structural repairs that are the governors' responsibility as set out in the Scheme for the Local Management of Schools;
- report all defects and hazards to the relevant officers in the EA (NER);
- ensure that all accidents to children, teaching staff and non-teaching staff are reported promptly to the EA (NER); and
- ensure that all staff operate safe working practices in the execution of their duties.
- Health and safety induction is carried out for all new staff (appendix 1)

In the absence of the principal the vice-principal, acting principal or nominated senior teacher will assume the role.

Building Supervisor

The building supervisor's line manager is the Principal

In the discharge of this responsibility the building supervisor will:

- ensure that routine maintenance checks and inspections required by legislation of fixed service equipment, i.e. boilers, pressure vessels etc. are undertaken
- ensure that premises safety inspections are undertaken e.g. weekly, bi-termly, and keep records of any faults identified (if appropriate);
- attend to defect reports and recommendations from the principal and staff,
- ensure that all portable electrical equipment is tested on an annual basis;
- ensure all accidents within the area of responsibility are recorded in line with the school policy;
- ensure equipment, including personal protection equipment is maintained in a safe condition and that substances hazardous to health are stored in a safe place.
- carry out or allocate the undertaking of risk assessments which include manual handling, COSHH, and to ensure details are documented and that appropriate action is carried out;
- liaising with contractors and maintenance contractors.
- assist the Principal and Governors in actioning the annual Health and Safety plan.

Teaching Staff

Each member of the teaching staff has a responsibility to exercise care and attention regarding the safety of themselves and pupils under their control. In the discharge of this responsibility all teachers shall:

- ensure that they take reasonable care during work activities to avoid accident or injury to themselves, other members of staff and pupils;